

FROM RAW TASK LIST TO OPTIMISED DAY PLAN

Let's put it all together into a repeatable daily system any reader can adopt, thanks to this conceptual workflow given below...

Night-before planning ritual (10–15 minutes)

Goal: Turn tomorrow from “we’ll see” into a clear, realistic plan.

1. Dump tasks:

- List everything you think you should do tomorrow (including meetings, personal chores, deep work, etc.).

2. Share calendar snapshot:

- Either paste your agenda (many calendar apps have a “Schedule view” text format) or describe fixed events.

3. Prompt to ChatGPT/Gemini:

“Act as my personal productivity coach.

Here is my calendar for tomorrow:

[paste agenda or describe fixed blocks]

Here is my task list:

[paste tasks]

Constraints:

- I work best 10:00–13:00 and 16:00–18:00.
- I want one 60–90 minute deep work block, one 30-minute admin block, and one 30-minute learning slot.
- I need at least 30 minutes for lunch and 2 short breaks.

- Prioritise my tasks using an Eisenhower-style approach.
- Create a time-boxed schedule for tomorrow that fits tasks around my existing meetings.
- Limit scheduled tasks so I have at least 1 hour of slack/unplanned time.
- Output in a simple timeline format I can copy into my notes.”

4. Reality tweak:

- If it looks too dense, reply:
“This still looks too packed for me. Remove or defer 2–3 lower-impact tasks and leave more slack.”

5. Lock it in:

- Copy the final schedule into your notes or a “Tomorrow” page in your planner.

Morning reset (5 minutes)

When you sit down at your desk:

1. Read the AI-generated schedule.
2. Ask:
“Given that I woke up feeling [tired/energetic] and [any changes], tweak this plan to reflect my current energy while still keeping the top priorities.”
3. Adjust 1–2 blocks (e.g. swap deep work to later if you slept badly).

Mid-day check-in (5–10 minutes)

Around lunch:

1. Prompt:
“Here’s what I actually did in the morning vs the plan: [describe briefly].
Help me:
1. Update the afternoon schedule realistically.
2. Pick 1 top-priority task for after lunch that will make me feel accomplished.”
2. Let AI reshuffle tasks and encourage a reset instead of declaring the day ruined.

End-of-day reflection (10 minutes)

At the end of the day:

“Today’s plan vs reality:

- Planned: [paste or summarise]
 - Did: [what you actually did, 5–7 bullets]
 - Distractions: [social, phone, surprise meetings, etc.]
1. Summarise the day in 5 bullet points.
 2. Identify 2 things I did well.
 3. Identify 2 patterns that hurt my productivity.
 4. Suggest 3 small tweaks for tomorrow’s plan.
Don’t be harsh.”

Use those tweaks in your night-before ritual. You’ve created a daily feedback loop with AI instead of flying blind.

■ Research & decision support:

- Use Perplexity when you need sources (e.g. productivity frameworks, deep work concepts, etc.) with citations.

■ Communication:

- Let Gemini/ChatGPT draft emails and summaries; you only edit and send.

■ Accountability:

- Use your favourite chat-based AI as a daily log (like a private productivity diary).

In the next chapter, we’ll take the same AI superpowers and point them at learning new skills—so your 2026 isn’t just more productive, it’s also more capable. **d**